Master's Thesis: Status and Plan

Biofilm growth coupled into the IKM FEM element, following Klempt et al.

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Since the last meeting: the scope of the FEM part is fixed

Thesis

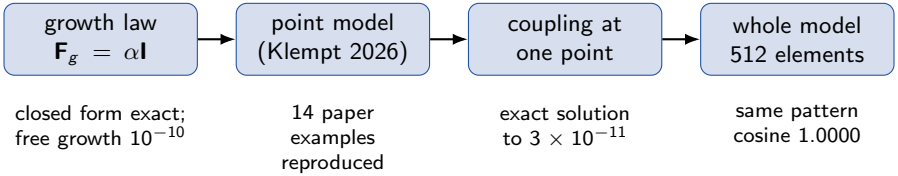
- **one and two species**
- coupled into the IKM element (Klempt et al. 2024)
- composition from the point model (Klempt et al. 2026)

Continuation at Keio

- more species (from four)
- two-way coupling

One and two species can be checked against published examples.

Verification, step by step



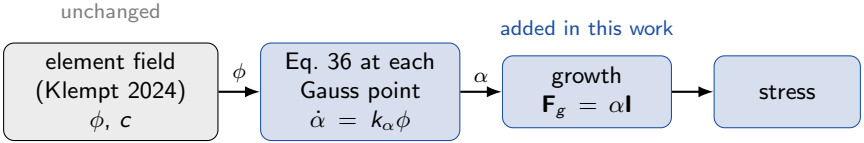
Each step is checked before the next one builds on it.

- point model: two misprints in Klempt et al. 2026 identified (no $+\gamma$ in Eq. 17, no $\frac{1}{2}$ in Eq. 19)
- same point model in Fritsch et al. 2025: their figures reproduced within 0.013

The coupling: what the element does and what is added

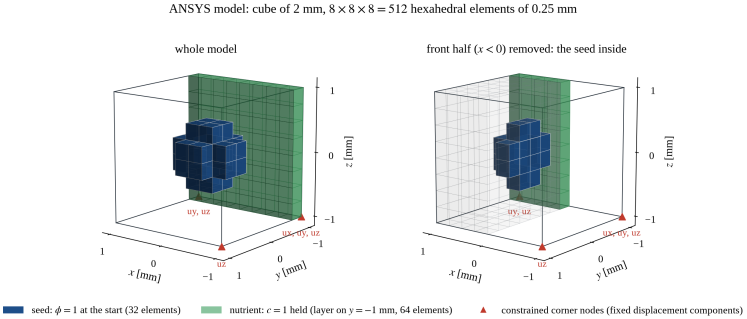
The element solves the biofilm field of Klempt et al. 2024 (Eq. 34):

$$\dot{\phi} - \beta\,\Delta\phi - k_\alpha\,\alpha + |\nabla\phi|\,r\,\frac{c}{k+c}\,\mathbf{n}_\phi \cdot \mathbf{n}_c = 0$$



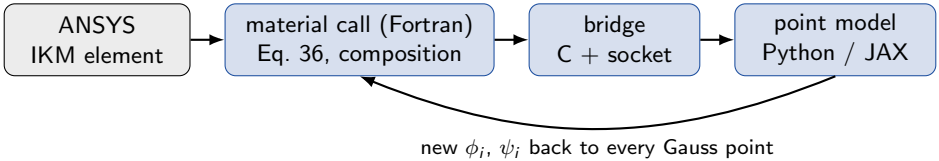
Klempt 2024 Table 2: $k_\alpha = 10^{-3}$, $E = 10$ Pa, $\nu = 0.49$. β, r, k, d, g: the framework's example input, not from the paper.

Model and boundary conditions



- 2 mm cube, 512 elements; only rigid-body motion fixed
- nutrient $c = 1$ on the face $y = -1$ mm; seed of 32 elements with $\phi = 1$
- uniform growth is stress free; stress comes from differences in growth
- used for Checks 1–3 and the two-species runs (ANSYS); the Klempt 2024 reproduction uses the paper's 20 μm cube (Python)

What I implemented



speed single-element run 357 s → **5.6 s**

check every ANSYS call replayed in Python, difference 0

used as it is

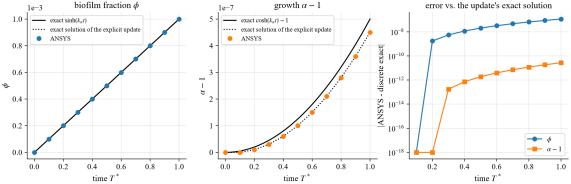
- IKM element: field, stiffness
- point-model equations (Klempt et al. 2026)

written in this work

- Eq. 36 and the composition step in the material call
- Fortran → Python bridge, sub-stepping
- point-model solver (JAX): all 14 paper examples
- checks: closed form in ANSYS, call replay, about 440 tests

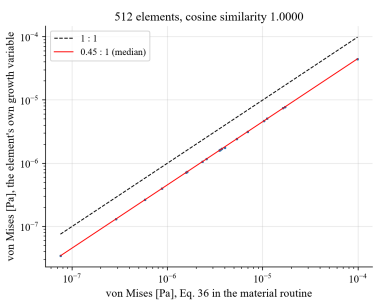
Checks 1 and 2: exact solution and whole model

1. Exact solution



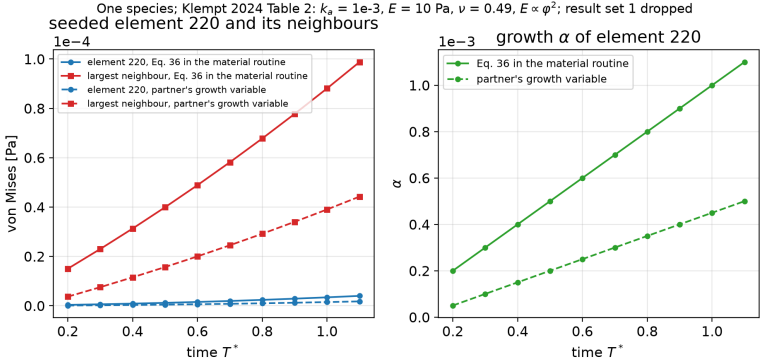
α matches to 3×10^{-11}

2. Whole model, 512 elements



same pattern (cosine 1.0000); factor $0.455 = \frac{1}{2} \cdot \frac{10}{11}$

Check 3: the seeded element and its neighbours



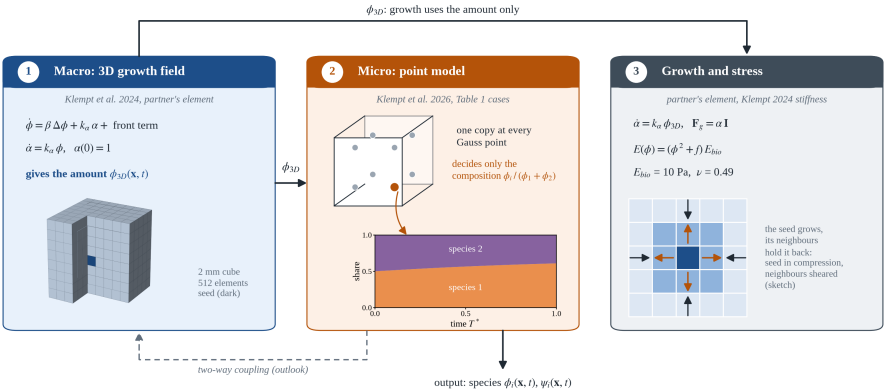
- $\alpha - 1 = 1.1 \times 10^{-3} = k_\alpha \phi t$, as Eq. 36 says
- seed compressed; neighbours carry about 25× its von Mises stress
- stresses $\leq 10^{-4}$ Pa: slow growth, soft biofilm ($E = 10$ Pa)

Four things found along the way (partner element)

1. growth variable = mean of both species fields $\Rightarrow$ halved with one species
   the unused field stays at its start value; intended?
2. start values must satisfy $\phi_1 + \phi_2 \leq 1$
   the example input starts both at 1; for one species I start the second at 0
3. first result set not in equilibrium $\Rightarrow$ excluded
   zero stress on the first calls while the element sets up its operators
4. front-growth term inactive (reading slip) $\Rightarrow$ the seed does not spread
   it also uses $|\Delta\phi|$ where Eq. 34 has $|\nabla\phi|$; corrected in a test copy, ϕ exceeds 1

Questions for Oliver. Checks 1–3 do not depend on them.

Two species: composition from the point model (Klempt et al. 2026)



Point model run two ways: A) rescaled every step to ϕ_{3D}; B) started when ϕ_{3D} first reaches ϕ_{min}, then independent. Assumed, not from a paper: $s = 0.15$, $\phi_{cap} = 0.9$, $\phi_{min} = 0.01$.

- the field sets the **amount**, the point model the **composition**
- one-way: the composition does not act on the stress

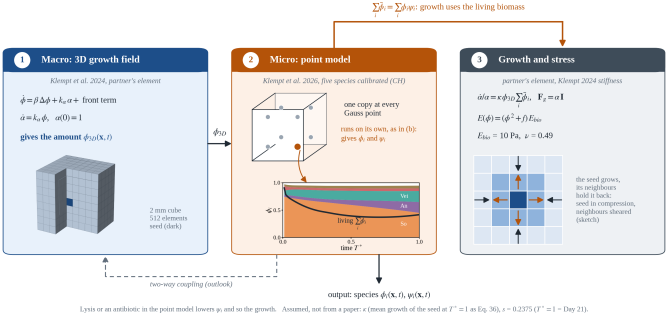
Two species: results in the packed seed (ANSYS, $T^* = 1$)

case (Klempt et al. 2026)	paper	coupled, $\phi_{\mathrm{cap}} = 0.9$	$\phi_{\mathrm{cap}} = 0.85$ / 0.95
3: coexistence	0.60	0.667	0.668 / 0.664
6: one species wins	≈ 0 ($\psi_1 = 0.05$)	0.021 ($\psi_1 = 0.048$)	–

share $\phi_1/(\phi_1 + \phi_2)$; paper: point model alone; parameters $c^* = 100$, $\alpha^* = 10$

- same type of outcome; the ratio shifts because the field sets the amount
- converged in the coupling time step

Added since 5 October: growth from the living biomass



Lysis or an antibiotic in the point model lowers ψ_i and so the growth. Assumed, not from a paper: κ (mean growth of the seed at $T^* = 1$ as Eq. 36), $s = 0.2375$ ($T^* = 1$ = Day 21).

Eq. 36 uses the amount: $\dot{\alpha} = k_\alpha \phi$.
Here: $\dot{\alpha}/\alpha = \kappa\, \phi_{3D} \sum_i \phi_i \psi_i$, so lysis in the point model lowers the growth.

κ chosen so that the mean growth of the seed equals Eq. 36 (an assumption, not from a paper; Appendix E).

seed means, $T^* = 1$	Eq. 36	living	diff.
$\alpha - 1$, 8^3	$6.752 \cdot 10^{-4}$	$6.752 \cdot 10^{-4}$	0.0 %
von Mises, 8^3 [Pa]	$4.684 \cdot 10^{-4}$	$4.357 \cdot 10^{-4}$	−7.0 %
von Mises, 16^3; 24^3			−8.0; −7.8 %
antibiotic vs. none, 8^3	0 %	−32 %	

five species calibrated (CH), $E = 10$ Pa; 16^3, 24^3 and the antibiotic case with the previous calibration

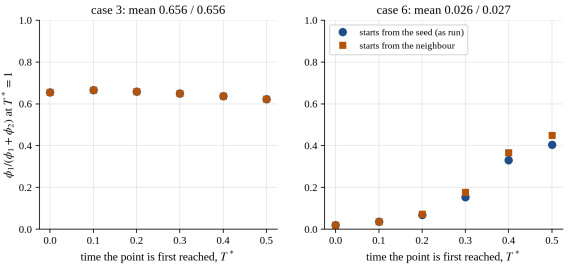
Two modelling assumptions

1. **time link** $s = 0.15$: point model advances $s\,\Delta t$ per step (no paper links the two time scales)
   case 6: winner appears for $s \gtrsim 0.15$; case 3: share moves by 0.03–0.06
2. **cap** $\phi_{\mathrm{cap}} = 0.9$ on the amount seen by the point model
   case 3: 0.664–0.668 for $\phi_{\mathrm{cap}} = 0.85$–$0.95$

All other parameters are the published values.

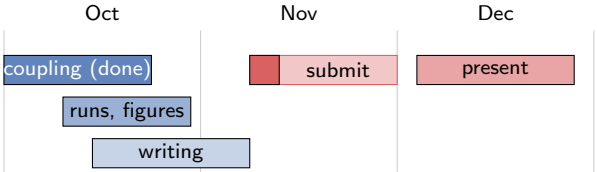
Limits

- composition is local, not carried with the front: effect on the mean ≤ 0.001 (right, Python)
- s has no source in a paper
- Eq. 34 as printed moves the colony instead of growing it (Appendix D)
- two α: the element's own and Eq. 36 are integrated separately (Check 2)



Composition at $T^* = 1$ of the points first reached at each time; Klempt 2024 test case 4.1 field (Python, 20 μm cube), Klempt 2026 cases 3 and 6.

Status and timeline



- admission granted 18 Aug 2026; examiners Prof. Junker (IKM), Dr. Wangenheim (IDS); supervisors Prof. Soleimani, Dr. Geisler; thesis in English
- NIFE internship completed (04.05–24.07), report submitted
- **submission in November** (aiming for early November); presentation in December, date to be fixed with both examiners

Questions for this meeting

1. **Scope:** one and two species in the thesis, more at Keio?
2. **Assumptions:** s and ϕ_{cap} with sensitivity studies acceptable?
3. **Keio:** anything needed for the double degree this term?
4. **Klempt et al. 2024:** form of Eq. 34/35, t_{ref}, unit of μ, Eq. 36 or Table 1?
5. **Structure:** TMCMC calibration, a short internship section, then the ANSYS coupling?
6. **Submission:** printed copies, electronic version, Keio side?

References

- Klempt, Soleimani, Junker (2023), PAMM: precursor spatial model
- Klempt, Soleimani, Wriggers, Junker (2024), Biomech. Model. Mechanobiol.: growth field, Eq. 34/36, Table 2
- Klempt, Geisler, Soleimani, Junker (2026), Arch. Appl. Mech.: multi-species point model, Table 1 cases
- Fritsch et al. (2025), arXiv:2512.15145: Bayesian updating, same model

Appendix A: notation

Growth field and mechanics (Klempt et al. 2024)

ϕ	biofilm volume fraction (0 = void, 1 = dense)
c	nutrient concentration
α	expansion variable, $\mathbf{F}_g = \alpha\mathbf{I}$, $\alpha(0) = 1$; growth is $\alpha - 1$
$\mathbf{F} = \mathbf{F}_e\mathbf{F}_g$	elastic / growth split
k_α	growth factor (10^{-3} per T^*)
β	phase-field regularisation
r, k	front growth rate, Monod constant
T^*	normalised time, $T^* \in [0, 1]$

Point model (Klempt et al. 2026)

ϕ_i	volume fraction of species i
ϕ_0	void, $\phi_0 = 1 - \sum_i \phi_i$
ψ_i	living fraction (viability) of species i
γ	Lagrange multiplier for $\sum \phi_i + \phi_0 = 1$
A_{ij}	interaction matrix (self, cooperation, competition)
b_i	sensitivity to the antibiotic
c^*, α^*	nutrient, antibiotic concentration
η_i	viscosity (time scale) of species i

Coupling (this work)

ϕ_{3D}	amount from the element field
$\phi_i / \sum_j \phi_j$	composition (share of species i)
s	time link: point model advances $s\,\Delta t$
ϕ_{cap}	largest amount the point model sees

Appendix B: background, growth field and mechanics

Kinematics. Growth is a volume change: $\mathbf{F} = \mathbf{F}_e\mathbf{F}_g$ with isotropic $\mathbf{F}_g = \alpha\mathbf{I}$. Stress comes only from $\mathbf{F}_e$ (neo-Hookean). A body that can grow freely stays stress free; stress appears where growth is constrained.

Material (Klempt et al. 2024, Eq. 20 and Table 2): $E = 10$ Pa, $\nu = 0.49$, stiffness weighted with ϕ^2 (void: floor $10^{-3}E$); no viscosity. Stresses scale linearly with E (the example input's 1000 MPa gives $10^8\times$ larger values).

Field equations (Klempt et al. 2024, from an extended Hamilton principle):

$$\dot{\phi} = \underbrace{\beta\,\Delta\phi}_{\text{diffusion}} + \underbrace{k_\alpha\,\alpha}_{\text{local source}} - \underbrace{r\,\frac{c}{k+c}\,\nabla\phi\cdot\frac{\nabla c}{|\nabla c|}}_{\text{front growth towards nutrient}}\,, \qquad \dot{\alpha} = k_\alpha\,\phi$$

- ϕ and c are nodal fields of the element; α is an internal variable at the Gauss points
- The front term moves the biofilm boundary up the nutrient gradient; it vanishes where ϕ or c is uniform
- The nutrient diffuses much faster than the biofilm grows (quasi-static c)

Appendix C: point model and one substep of the coupled run

Point model (Klempt et al. 2026), per species i, no space dependence, implicit, $\Delta t = 10^{-4}$:

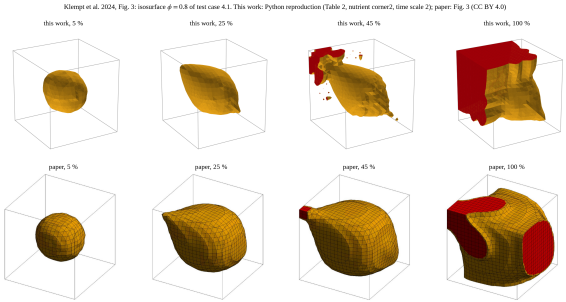
$$(\eta_{\phi,i} + \eta_i \psi_i^2)\,\dot{\phi}_i + \eta_i \phi_i \psi_i\,\dot{\psi}_i = c^* \psi_i \textstyle\sum_j A_{ij}\phi_j\psi_j - \gamma - (\text{barrier})$$

$$\eta_i\,(\phi_i \psi_i\,\dot{\phi}_i + \phi_i^2\,\dot{\psi}_i) = c^* \phi_i \textstyle\sum_j A_{ij}\phi_j\psi_j - \alpha^* b_i\,\psi_i - (\text{barrier}), \qquad \textstyle\sum_i \phi_i + \phi_0 = 1$$

One substep $t_n \to t_{n+1}$: ANSYS solves only $\operatorname{div}\boldsymbol{\sigma} = \mathbf{0}$; the material routine turns $\mathbf{F}$ into $\boldsymbol{\sigma}$ after removing the growth.

repeat (Newton iteration of ANSYS)
  $\mathbf{F}$ at every Gauss point from the current displacements
  for each Gauss point
    $\phi_{3D} = \phi_1 + \phi_2$ from the element; restore the converged state of t_n
    $\alpha_{n+1} = \alpha_n + k_\alpha\,\phi_{3D}\,\Delta t$ Eq. 36
    $\mathbf{F}_e = \mathbf{F}\,\mathbf{F}_g^{-1}$, $\mathbf{F}_g = \alpha_{n+1}\mathbf{I}$ $\to$ $\boldsymbol{\sigma}$, tangent
    if two species and $\phi_{3D} \geq \phi_{\min}$:
      scale the point model to $\min(\phi_{3D}, \phi_{\mathrm{cap}})$
      bridge (Fortran $\to$ C $\to$ socket $\to$ Python): n_{sub} steps of $s\Delta t/n_{\mathrm{sub}}$
      scale back; store ϕ_i, ψ_i, γ as state variables
    return $\boldsymbol{\sigma}$ and the tangent to ANSYS
  assemble the residual, update the displacements
until converged
the element advances ϕ_1, ϕ_2, c to t_{n+1} (its own solver)

Appendix D: Klempt et al. 2024 test cases, reproduced in Python



test case	time scale	RMS ϕ	RMS c
4.1 (Fig. 4)	2	0.03	0.02
4.2 “high” (Fig. 7)	10	0.04	0.04
4.2 “low” (Fig. 7)	4–5	0.09	0.05

Independent solver on the paper's 20 μm cube, not the ANSYS model. Table 2 unchanged; growth on both faces and consumption $g\phi c$ (two departures from Eq. 34/35 as printed); nutrient in a 2 μm corner block; one time scale per run ($T^* = t/t_{\mathrm{ref}}$, Sec. 4). Curves agree; the shape agrees in kind (egg towards the corner) but is more slender, also with other diffusion and a 2nd-order scheme. Table 3's pressure fits μ in MPa.

Appendix E: growth from the living biomass, implementation and runs

Change in the material routine (Appendix C, line 5 only):

$$\ln \alpha_{n+1} = \ln \alpha_n + \kappa \, \phi_{3D} \int_{t_n}^{t_{n+1}} \sum_i \phi_i \psi_i \, dt$$

- same form as Klempt 2024 Table 1 (increment of $\ln \alpha$); $\phi_{3D} \in [0, 1]$ marks where the biofilm is
- point model at each Gauss point runs on its own (not scaled to ϕ_{3D}), started when $\phi_{3D} \geq \phi_{\min}$ from the calibrated Day-1 state
- integral over the point model's own substeps, clock s per unit T^*
- point-model state kept as state variables; the element itself unchanged
- $\kappa = 8.14 \cdot 10^{-3}$: the mean $\alpha - 1$ of the seed at $T^* = 1$ equals Eq. 36 (difference $-0.003\,\%$); assumed, not from a paper

seed means, $T^* = 1$	Eq. 36	living	diff.
$\alpha - 1$, 8^3	$6.752 \cdot 10^{-4}$	$6.752 \cdot 10^{-4}$	0.0 %
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antibiotic vs. none, 8^3	0 %	−32 %	

five species calibrated (CH), $E = 10$ Pa, $\nu = 0.49$; 16^3, 24^3 and the antibiotic case with the previous calibration.

- the difference is not in the amount but in how the growth is spread inside the seed (von Mises/$(\alpha - 1)$ 0.69 $\rightarrow$ 0.64 Pa)
- $\alpha - 1$ and the stress scale with κ
- antibiotic: in Eq. 36 only the composition changes; here the growth drops (same sensitivity for all species, strength assumed)